第二十七回
滴翠亭杨妃戏彩蝶
埋香冢飞燕泣残红



话说黛玉正自悲泣，忽听院门响处，只见宝钗出来了，宝玉、袭人一群人都送出来。待要上去问着宝玉，又恐当着众人问羞了宝玉不便，因而闪过一旁，让宝钗去了，宝玉等进去关了门，方转过来，尚望着门洒了几点泪。自觉无味，转身回来，无精打彩的卸了残妆。

紫鹃雪雁素日知道黛玉的情性：无事闷坐，不是愁眉，便是长叹，且好端端的，不知为着什么，常常的便自泪不干的。先时还有人解劝，或怕他思父母，想家乡，受委屈，用话来宽慰。谁知后来一年一月的，竟是常常如此，把这个样儿看惯了，也都不理论了。所以也没人去理他，由他闷坐，只管外间自便去了。

那黛玉倚着床栏杆，两手抱着膝，眼睛含着泪，好似木雕泥塑的一般，直坐到二更多天，方才睡了。一宿无话。

至次日乃是四月二十六日，原来这日未时交芒种节。尚古风俗：凡交芒种节的这日，都要设摆各色礼物，祭饯花神，——言芒种一过，便是夏日了，众花皆卸，花神退位，须要饯行。闺中更兴这件风俗，

“呆雁在那里呢？我也瞧瞧。”黛玉道：“我才出来，他就‘忒儿’的一声飞了。”口里说着，将手里的绢子一甩，向宝玉脸上甩来，宝玉不知，正打在眼上，“嗳哟”了一声。要知端的，下回分解。



第三十一回
撕扇子作千金一笑
因麒麟伏白首双星



话说袭人见了自己吐的鲜血在地，也就冷了半截，想着往日常听人说："少年吐血，年月不保；纵然命长，终是废人了。"想起此言，不觉将素日想着后来争荣夸耀之心，尽皆灰了；眼中不觉的滴下泪来。宝玉见他哭了，也不觉心酸起来，因问道："你心里觉着怎么样？"袭人勉强笑道："好好儿的，觉怎么样呢！"

宝玉的意思即刻便要叫人烫黄酒，要山羊血嵯峨丸来。袭人拉着他的手，笑道："你这一闹不大紧，闹起多少人来，倒抱怨我轻狂。分明人不知道，倒闹的人知道了，你也不好，我也不好。正经明儿你打发小子问问王大夫去，弄点子药吃吃就好了。人不知鬼不觉的，不好吗？"宝玉听了有理，也只得罢了；向案上斟了茶来，给袭人漱口。袭人知宝玉心内也不安，待要不叫他伏侍，他又必不依；况且定要惊动别人，不如且由他去罢：因此倚在榻上，由宝玉去伏侍。

那天刚亮，宝玉也顾不得梳洗，忙穿衣出来，将王济仁叫来，亲自确问。王济仁问其原故，不过是伤损，便说了个丸药的名字，怎么吃，怎么敷。宝玉记了，回园来，依方调治，不在话下。

这日正是端阳佳节，蒲艾簪门，虎符系<背>，午间王夫人治了酒席，请薛家母女等过节。宝玉见宝钗淡淡的，也不和他说话，自知是昨日的原故。王夫人见宝玉没精打彩，也只当是昨日金钏儿之事，他

没好意思的，越发不理他。黛玉见宝玉懒懒的，只当是他因为得罪了宝钗的原故，心中不受用，形容也就懒懒的。凤姐昨日晚上王夫人就告诉了他宝玉金钏儿的事，知道王夫人不喜欢，自己如何敢说笑，也就随着王夫人的气色行事，更觉淡淡的。迎春姐妹见众人没意思，也都没意思了。因此，大家坐了一坐，就散了。

那黛玉天性喜散不喜聚，他想的也有个道理。他说："人有聚就有散，聚时喜欢，到散时岂不清冷？既清冷则生感伤，所以不如倒是不聚的好。比如那花儿开的时候儿叫人爱，到谢的时候儿便增了许多惆怅，所以倒是不开的好。"故此，人以为欢喜时，他反以为悲恸。那宝玉的性情只愿人常聚不散，花常开不谢；及到筵散花谢，虽有万种悲伤，也就没奈何了。因此今日之筵，大家无兴散了，黛玉还不觉怎么着，倒是宝玉心中闷闷不乐，回至房中，长吁短叹。

偏偏晴雯上来换衣裳，不防又把扇子失了手，掉在地下，将骨子跌折。宝玉因叹道："蠢才，蠢才！将来怎么样！明日你自己当家立业，难道也是这么顾前不顾后的？"晴雯冷笑道："二爷近来气大的很，行动就给脸子瞧。前儿连袭人都打了，今儿又来寻我的不是。要踢要打凭爷去。——就是跌了扇子，也算不的什么大事；先时候儿什么玻璃缸，玛瑙碗，不知弄坏了多少，也没见个大气儿。这会子一把扇子就这么着。何苦来呢！嫌我们就打发了我们，再挑好的使。好离好散的倒不好？"

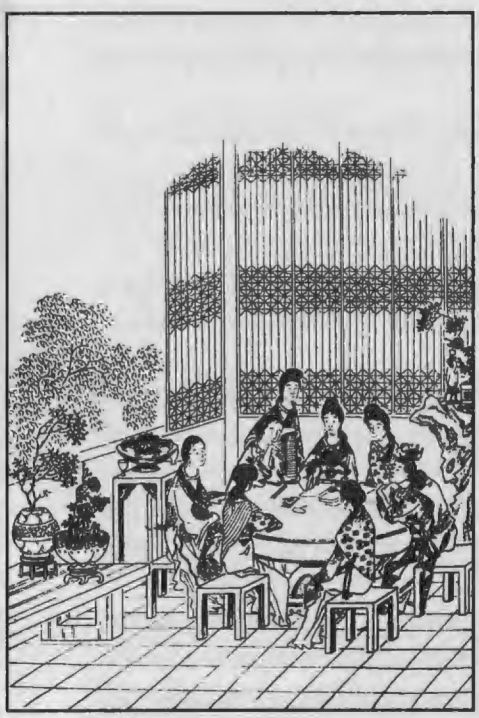
宝玉听了这些话，气的浑身乱战。因说道："你不用忙，将来横竖有散的日子！"袭人在那边早已听见，忙赶过来，向宝玉道："好好儿的，又怎么了？可是我说的：'一时我不到就有事故儿。'"晴雯听了冷笑道："姐姐既会说，就该早来呀，省了我们惹的生气。自古以来，就只是你一个人会伏侍，我们原不会伏侍。因为你伏侍的好，<昨日才挨窝心脚>。我们不会伏侍的，明日还不知犯什么罪呢？"

倒凉快，吹一吹再走。”又告诉众人道：“你们说我回了这半日的话！太太把二百年的事都想起来问我，难道我不说罢？”又冷笑道：“我从今以后，倒要干几件刻薄事了。抱怨给太太听，我也不怕！糊涂油蒙了心、烂了舌头、不得好死的下作娼妇们，别做娘的春梦了！明儿一裹脑子扣的日子还有呢。如今裁了丫头的钱，就抱怨了。<咱们也不想一想是奴几，>也配使两三个丫头！”一面骂，一面方走了，自去挑人回贾母话去，不在话下。

却说薛姨妈等这里吃毕西瓜，又说了一回闲话儿，各自散去。宝钗与黛玉回至园中，宝钗要约着黛玉往藕香榭去，黛玉因说：“还要洗澡。”便各自散了。宝钗独自行来，顺路进了怡红院，竟欲寻宝玉去说话儿，以解午倦。不想步入院中，鸦雀无闻，一并连两只仙鹤在芭蕉下都睡着了。宝钗便顺着游廊，来至房中，只见外间床上横三竖四，都是丫头们睡觉。转过十锦槅子，来至宝玉的房内，宝玉在床上睡着了，袭人坐在身旁，手里做针线，傍边放着一柄白犀麈。

宝钗走近前来，悄悄的笑道：“你也过于小心了。这个屋里还有苍蝇蚊子？还拿蝇刷子赶什么？”袭人不防，猛抬头见是宝钗，忙放针线起身，悄悄笑道：“姑娘来了！我倒不防，唬了一跳。——姑娘不知道：虽然没有苍蝇蚊子，谁知有一种小虫子，从这纱眼里钻进来，人也看不见；只睡着了，咬一口，就象蚂蚁叮的。”宝钗道：“怨不得。这屋子后头又近水，又都是香花儿，

第三十八回
林潇湘魁夺菊花诗
薛蘅芜讽和螃蟹咏



话说宝钗湘云计议已定，一宿无话。次日湘云便请贾母等赏桂花。贾母等都说道："倒是他有兴头，须要扰他这雅兴。"至午，果然贾母带了王夫人凤姐，兼请薛姨妈等进园来。贾母因问："那一处好？"王夫人道："凭老太太爱在那一处，就在那一处。"凤姐道："藕香榭已经摆下了。那山坡下两棵桂花开的又好，河里的水又碧清，坐在河当中亭子上，不敞亮吗？看看水，眼也清亮。"

贾母听了，说："很好。"说着，引了众人往藕香榭来。原来这藕香榭盖在池中，四面有窗，左右有回廊，也是跨水接峰，后面又有曲折桥。众人上了竹桥，凤姐忙上来搀着贾母，口里说道："老祖宗只管迈大步走，不相干，这竹子桥规矩是'硌吱硌吱'的。"

一时进入榭中，只见栏杆外另放着两张竹案，一个上面设着杯箸酒具，一个上头设着茶筅茶具各色盏碟。那边有两三个丫头煽风炉煮茶；这边另有几个丫头也煽风炉烫酒呢。贾母忙笑问："这茶想的很好，且是地方东西都干净。"湘云笑道："这是宝姐姐帮

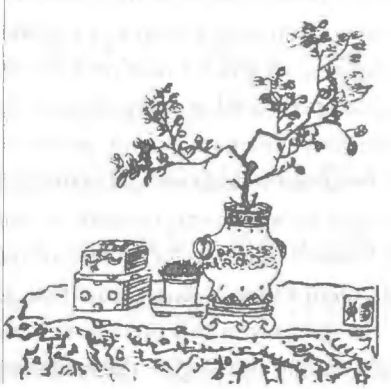
太太还是回屋里去歇歇罢。若高兴，明日再来逛逛。”贾母听了，笑道：“正是呢。我怕你们高兴，我走了，又怕扫了你们的兴；既这么说，咱们就都去罢。”回头嘱咐湘云：“别让你宝哥哥多吃了。”湘云答应着。又嘱咐湘云宝钗二人说：“你们两个也别多吃了。那东西虽好吃，不是什么好的，吃多了肚子疼。”

二人忙应着，送出园外，仍旧回来，命将残席收拾了另摆。宝玉道：“也不用摆，咱们且做诗。把那大团圆桌子放在当中，酒菜都放着，也不必拘定坐位，有爱吃的去吃，大家散坐，岂不便宜？”宝钗道：“这话极是。”湘云道：“虽这么说，还有别人。”因又命另摆一桌，拣了热螃蟹来，请袭人、紫鹃、司棋、侍书、入画、莺儿、翠墨等一处共坐。山坡桂树底下铺下两条花毯，命支应的婆子并小丫头等也都坐了，只管随意吃喝，等使唤再来。

湘云便取了诗题，用针绾在墙上，众人看了，都说：“新奇！只怕做不出来。”湘云又把不限韵的缘故说了一番，宝玉道：“这才是正理。我也最不喜限韵。”黛玉[因不大吃酒，又不吃螃蟹，]自命人掇了一个绣墩，倚栏坐着，拿着钓杆钓鱼。宝钗手里拿着一枝桂花，玩了一回，俯在窗槛上，掐了桂蕊，扔在水面，引的那游鱼汹上来唼喋。湘云出一回神，又让一回袭人等，又招呼山坡下的众人只管放量吃。探春和李纨惜春正立在垂柳阴中看鸥鹭。迎春却独在花阴下，拿着个针儿穿茉莉花。宝玉又看了一回黛

我且替你收着，等你用着这个的时候我送你些。——也只可留着画扇子：若画这大幅的，也就可惜了。今儿替你开个单子，照着单子和老太太要去。你们也未必知道的全，我说着，宝兄弟写。”宝玉早已预备下笔砚了，原怕记不清白，要写了记着，——听宝钗如此说，喜的提起笔来静听。

宝钗说道：“头号排笔四支，二号排笔四支，三号排笔四支，大染四支，中染四支，小染四支，大南蟹爪十支，小蟹爪十支，须眉十支，大着色二十支，小着色二十支，开面十支，柳条二十支，箭头朱四两，南赭四两，石黄四两，石青四两，石绿四两，管黄四两，广花八两，＜蛤粉四匣，胭脂十片，＞大赤二百帖，青金二百帖，广匀胶四两，净矾四两，——矾绢的胶矾在外，别管他们，只把绢交出去，叫他们矾去。这些颜色，咱们淘澄飞跌着，又玩了，又使了，包你一辈子都够使了。再要顶细绢箩四个，粗箩二个，担



早已定了。等到了明日临期，横竖知道。”说毕，大家又说了一回闲话，方往贾母处来，当日无话。

到了次日清早，宝玉因心里惦记着，这一夜没好生得睡，天亮了，就爬起来掀起帐子一看，虽然门窗尚掩，只是窗上光辉夺目，心内早踌躇起来，埋怨定是晴了，日光已出。一面忙起来揭起窗屉，从玻璃窗内往外一看，原来不是日光，竟是一夜的雪，下的将有一尺厚，天上仍是搓绵扯絮一般。

宝玉此时喜欢非常，忙唤起人来，盥漱已毕，只穿一件茄色哆罗呢狐狸皮袄，罩一件海龙小鹰膀褂子，束了腰，披上玉针蓑，带了金藤笠，登上沙棠屐，忙忙的往芦雪庭来。出了院门，四顾一望，并无二色，远远的是青松翠竹，自己却似装在玻璃盆内一般。于是走至山坡之下顺着山脚，刚转过去，已闻得一股寒香扑鼻，回头一看，却是妙玉那边栊翠庵中有十数枝红梅，如胭脂一般，映着雪色，分外显得精神，好不有趣。

宝玉便立住，细细的赏玩了一回方走。只见蜂腰板桥上一个人打着伞走来，是李纨打发了请凤姐儿去的人。宝玉来至芦雪庭，只见丫头婆子正在那里扫雪开径。原来这芦雪庭盖在一个傍山临水河滩之上，一带几间茅檐土壁，横篱竹牖，推窗便可垂钓，四面皆是芦苇掩覆，一条去径，逶迤穿芦度苇过去，便是藕香榭的竹桥了。众丫头婆子见他披蓑带笠而来，都笑道：“我们才说正少一个渔翁，如今

傍边一副对联，写道是：

已后儿孙承福得；

至今黎庶念宁荣。

俱是御笔。里边灯烛辉煌，锦幛绣幕，虽列着些神主，却看不真。

只见贾府人分了昭穆，排班立定。贾敬主祭，贾赦陪祭，贾珍献爵，贾琏贾琮献帛，宝玉捧香，贾蓉贾菱展拜垫，守焚池。青衣乐奏，三献爵，兴拜毕，焚帛，奠酒。礼毕，乐止，退出。众人围随贾母至正堂上。影前锦帐高挂，彩屏张护，香烛辉煌；上面正居中，悬着荣宁二祖遗像，皆是披蟒腰玉；两边还有几轴列祖遗像。

贾荇贾芷等从内仪门挨次站列，直到正堂廊下；槛外方是贾敬贾赦，槛内是各女眷。众家人小厮皆在仪门之外。每一道菜至，传至仪门，贾荇贾芷等便接了，按次传至阶下贾敬手中。贾蓉系长房长孙，独他随女眷在槛里，每贾敬捧菜至，传于贾蓉，贾蓉便传于他媳妇，又传于凤姐尤氏诸人，直传至供桌前，方传与王夫人；王夫人传与贾母，贾母方捧放



It is surprising yet instructive to recall that when Roger Ames published his groundbreaking translation and philosophical analysis of the ninth essay of the *Huai-nan Tzu, Chu-shu (The Art of Rulership)* in 1983, most Western scholars looked upon the text as an eclectic and unoriginal restatement of the great philosophers of the pre-Han age. It had been two decades since Benjamin Wallacker had provided us with his explicitly literal translation of the *Huai-nan Tzu's* eleventh essay, "Placing Customs on a Par" *(Ch'i su)* (American Oriental Society, 1962) and even longer since Eva Kraft's German translation of the first two essays, "The Original Way" *(Yüan-Tao)* and "The Primeval Reality" *(Ch'u-chen)*, appeared in *Monumenta Serica* (1957, 1958). The time was right for a comprehensive study that would not only translate one essay from this complex text, but help us to appreciate its unique syncretic genius and contribution to Chinese thought.

Such a study needed to do more than just point out which of the *Huai-nan Tzu's* ideas was drawn from which earlier thinker. It had to show not merely *what* was borrowed, but *how* it was transformed to suit a new vision that was being set forth by the *Huai-nan Tzu* authors. Roger Ames did this by providing a clear and compelling analysis of the intellectual background of the key concepts that the author of *Huai-nan Tzu* 9 adapted from earlier philosophical traditions. By studying how such terms as "penal law" *(fa)*, "utilizing the people" *(yung chung)*, and "benefitting the people" *(li-min)* were understood in their earlier Legalist and Confucian contexts, Ames was able to demonstrate how their meanings transformed when they were set within a Taoist cosmology and political agenda, whose essential outline is derived from the *Lao Tzu*.

Let us for a moment consider the example of how one of the concepts, penal law *(fa)*, is transformed in *The Art of Rulership*. To the Legalist authors Shang Yang and Han Fei, laws and concomittent punishments are indispensable for social order because they intimidate the masses into compliance with what is necessary to maintain the state and the ruler. The ruler is beyond all laws, which are controlled by him to serve his interests, as Ames notes in his analysis (131-32). *Huai-nan Tzu 9*, at variance with both this position and the earlier primitivism of the *Lao Tzu* that regards laws as cultural evils,

By contrast, the disdain which the *Lao Tzu* directs at this same culture leads to its insistence that one must unlearn conventional knowledge and reject all artificially established values before one can return to a natural and uncontaminated state. The cultural snowball which over the centuries has gathered around and given expression to the moral possibilities inherent in human nature is, to the Confucians, a source of intense pleasure and pride. For the *Lao Tzu* theorists, this cultural accumulation around one's original naturethis unnatural carving of the "uncarved block"represents a real deterioration of the human condition. In Confucius' interpretation of history, culture is both beneficially cumulative and progressive; for the Taoists, it is harmfully cumulative and retrogressive. Again, where the Confucian tradition credits history with a positive element of cultural evolution, the *Lao Tzu* tradition sees only a devolutionary slippage from a past utopian lifestyle. 27

Although this discussion has been based on the antique utopia depicted in the *Lao Tzu* 80, the notion of historical decline is one of the most popular and consistent themes in this kind of early Taoist literature. There are elaborations on this same *Lao Tzu* description in the "Primitivist" portion of the *Chuang Tzu*.28 In chapters 28 and 29 of the "Individualist" section of the *Chuang Tzu* text, there are also lengthy utopian passages. Again, beyond the Primitivist and Individualist areas of the *Chuang Tzu* the entire "Restoring the Original Nature" *(Shanhsing)* chapter, as the title implies, is devoted to a description of the corruption and fall of "natural" man.

Shang Yang and the Legalist Conception of History

> Since the ruler dwells deep in seclusion to avoid the heat and damp, and remains behind layer upon layer of doors in order to protect himself against villainy and insurgency, within he knows nothing about the towns and villages and without he knows nothing about the mountains and valleys. Beyond the curtains and hangings, one's eye cannot penetrate further than a few miles and the ear cannot hear beyond a hundred paces. Even so, he is wholly cognizant of all that goes on within the world because the sources that feed him are immense and those who tap him are numerous. Hence, without going beyond his doors, he knows about the world; without peeping out through his window, he comprehends the heavenly Way.

Here we have the overlap between the concept of *wu-wei* and the notion of utilizing the people *(yung chung)*. By assuming an attitude of *wu-wei*, the ruler makes it possible for the individuals in his society to seek their own realization and the development of their own faculties. At the same time, by tapping the concerted faculties of the populace at large to scan the operations of the state and register any irregularities, the ruler is able

The position of the ruler is defined by the retention of the *shih* available to his office (363:2): "The reason why a ruler of a ten-thousand-chariot state and the lord of a thousand-chariot state are in control of the empire and can punish the various nobles is because of their dignity and purchase. Dignity and purchase are the muscle and strength of the ruler." To safeguard his own control, the capable ruler permits no fluctuation in the privileges and duties available to an official (180:16): "A situation in which there is confusion and latitude in rights and duties is a source of disorder. Thus the perspicacious ruler is cautious with respect to it." If the ruler, abandoning his personal control over his purchase

3. I use the word "culture" in its broadest sense to indicate the sum total of social institutions, customs, and values created by people to regulate and refine their relationships. It is their formal expressionin social manners, music, literature, art, and the likeof a system of values which distinguishes civilized man from his primitive antecedents.

4. See *Analects* 34/16/8.

5. Ibid. 5/3/24, 13/7/23, 16/9/9, and 29/14/35.

6. Ibid. 13/7/20.

7. Ibid. 11/7/1.

8. Ibid. 15/8/19, 35/17/5, and 41/20/1.

9. Ibid. 5/3/25, 12/7/14, and 31/15/11.

10. Ibid. 4/3/9.

11. See *Tso chuan* 346/Chao 2/1: "The social norms *(li)* of Chou have been fully retained in the state of Lu."

12. See *Analects* 12/7/5 and 35/17/4.

13. Although the calendars of Chou and Yin took the eleventh and twelfth months of the lunar calendar respectively as the first month of the year, only the Hsia was reputed to have a calendar which began the year with the first month of the lunar calendar.

14. The state carriage of Yin was made of wood and simple in design. This phrase implies that Confucius preferred the austere appearance of this vehicle to the ornate and perhaps extravagant coaches of the Chou period.

56. See 235:15.

57. See 80:2.

58. See 68:14.

59. See 84:2.

60. See 238:5 and 242:10.

61. See 325:4.

62. For example, The Book of Lord Shang has a chapter entitled "Fixing Privileges and Duties" (Ting-fen). Fen is also an important expression in the "Commentary on Enlightened Laws" (Ming-fa-chieh) chapter of the Kuan Tzu.

63. Cf. The Book of Lord Shang 5/9a.

64. See 116:8: "The control of the government being invested in the ruler himself is called 'weightiness' (chung)." This is a commentary on Lao Tzu 26.

65. See 284:15. I follow the Ku Kuang-ts'e commentary in reading pu as hsia.

66. See Thompson, p. 234.

67. Hsü Fu-kuan, pp. 143-144, also detects a Confucian influence here.

6. Cf. Huai Nan Tzu 10/5b; Han Fei Tzu 17:16 and 30:14; Huang-ti ssu-ching, p. 31; and Shih Tzu A/6a.

7. Cf. Ta Tai li-chi 8/4a and Yen Tzu ch'un-ch'iu 7/11b.

8. See Lao Tzu 47 for similar purport.

9. I follow Wang Nien-sun. See Lao Tzu 63 and 64 for similar purport.

10. Compare the beginning of Chuang Tzu (chap. 11) and Lao Tzu 29.

11. This section is contained in Wen Tzu A/12a-b and A/10b-11a.

12. Cf. Record of Rites (Li-chi) 11/27, 7/1a, and 7/1b.

13. I follow Wen Tzu B/12a. See Wang Nien-sun's commentary in LWT 9/2a.

14. I follow Kao Heng's discussion on the Lao Tzu in Lao Tzu cheng-ku, pp. 51-52.

15. I follow Wen Tzu B/12a.

16. Shen Nung is a legendary ruler who, according to tradition, reigned from 2838 to 2698 B.C. He is particularly remembered as the sage who developed and taught husbandry. He is also the father of Chinese medicine, having devoted himself to the study of herbs and their properties.

17. Cf. Ta Tai li-chi l/3a and K'ung Tzu chia-yü l/9b.

18. The Ming T'ang was a sacred structure visited by the emperor in carrying out various sacrifices linked to the calendar. For lengthy (yet not altogether accurate) discussions on the Ming T'ang institution, see Granet, pp. 177 if., and Soothill, passim.

____. *Mencius*. Middlesex: Penguin, 1970.

____. *The Analects*. Middlesex: Penguin, 1979.

____. Review of H. G. Creel's *What Is Taoism and Other Studies in Chinese Cultural History. Asia Major* n.s. 18(1973): 121-123.

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